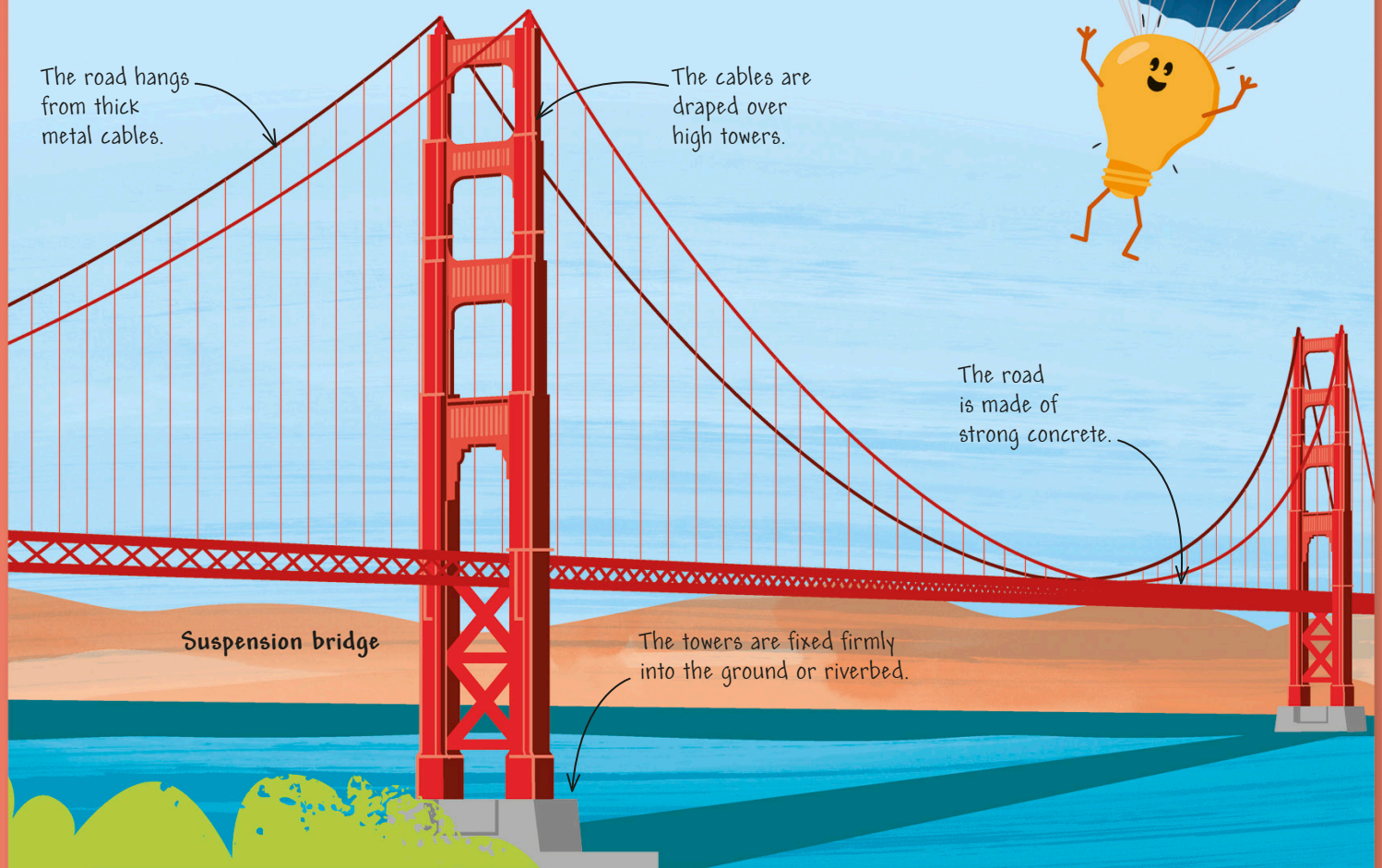


Bridges

If you find yourself facing a big gap you can't cross—you need to build a bridge! The first bridges were made of wood or stone. Today, most bridges are made of steel and concrete.

The Golden Gate Bridge in San Francisco is 8,981 ft (2,737 m) long!



Bridge types

There are several different types of bridge. When deciding what type to build, **engineers** think about whether the bridge will need to carry heavy or light loads, and whether it will be short or long.



Arch

This bridge is an arch, with each end fixed to the ground. Several arches with a road on top are used to cross a wide gap.



Truss

A truss bridge has a metal frame made of triangles, which are the strongest shapes. It can carry heavy loads.



Beam

A straight part, called the beam, rests on supports at each end. Long beam bridges also have supports in the middle.